with each other. According to a commentary in China's news agency Xinhua: "Paired up with China's Belt and Road Initiative (BRI), the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) under the guidance of the Shanghai Spirit is in the doorway to greater cooperation opportunities and expected to foster regional peace and development."[41]

By joining the SCO, India can think more sharply on how to respond to the BRI, and it should be consulting with Iran, Russia, and the Caucasus states in addition to with China to coordinate on various connectivity projects. Chinese expectations would be that the SCO will provide a fresh impetus for China, India, and Pakistan to talk together about the CPEC and help reduce India's misunderstanding of the project. At some stage, New Delhi too will have to find a way to reconcile with China's BRI without compromising on its core interest.

India and the China–Russia–US great power triangle

The Sino–Russian entente is one of the building blocks of the SCO. While China and Russia both have a strained relationship with the United States, India is building a closer relationship with the United States. India is approaching the SCO for building greater convergence with China and Russia in Eurasia, but if the Indo–US entente grows too strong and includes close military cooperation as well as promoting shared values and interests in Asia, this could contradict not only India's objectives but also the SCO's aspiration of becoming a counterpoise to Western dominance. Henceforth, the most delicate balancing act for India in the SCO is how it manages the China–Russia–US great power triangle.